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Question 1

Not answered

Marked out of 1

A research team sets out to review the evidence base for combining antidepressants to treat resistant depression. For the literature search to be complete which of the following strategy should not be followed?

Select one:

- ☐ Writing to experts for any missing studies
- ☐ Cross checking reference list from identified studies
- ☐ Using multiple databases to search
- ☐ Avoiding conference posters as data may not be peer reviewed
- ☐ Retrieving multiple language papers

Your answer is incorrect.

A properly conducted literature search must have following properties: 1. Using multiple databases - not just limiting to MEDLINE only or CINAHL only. 2. Cross checking the references list of each individual study retrieved by direct search 3. Hand searching for materials unidentified online. 4. Approaching experts to comment on any missing studies. 5. Identifying grey literature" i.e. the unpublished literature such as conference abstracts, presentations and posters.

The correct answer is: Avoiding conference posters as data may not be peer reviewed

Question 2

Not answered

Marked out of 1

While identifying the appropriate literature, the research team above finds 12 uncontrolled trials and 3 RCTs. Which of the following statement is true with regard to conducting a meta-analysis of above studies?

Select one:

- ☐ Meta-analysis is not feasible due to high publication bias
- ☐ Meta-analysis may be weak as study designs are different
- ☐ Meta-analysis can be performed but it will show a near zero effect size
- ☐ Meta-analysis is not indicated as 3 RCTs already exist.
- ☐ Meta-analysis cannot be performed as 15 studies are insufficient

Your answer is incorrect.

A meta-analysis is a statistical method of combining study results. It is best done using studies with a common methodology (all RCTs, all case-control studies), etc. But increasingly certain meta-analytical papers seem to override this tradition. Having small number of studies does not prevent, but weaken a meta-analysis. One cannot predict effect size of a meta-analysis without looking at the effects in individual trials. One may find the degree of publication bias while conducting a meta-analysis; high degree of bias can make the effect of outcome questionable. But this will not stop one from attempting a meta-analysis. Some authors argue that meta-analyses pooling significantly heterogeneous studies have limited validity, though it is possible to combine studies of different methodologies. It is best to conduct 2 separate meta-analysis – one for RCTs and one for uncontrolled trials.

The correct answer is: Meta-analysis may be weak as study designs are different

Question 3

Not answered

Marked out of 1

The highest place in the hierarchy of evidence is given to which of the following studies?

Select one:

- ☐ A dramatic uncontrolled experiment.
- ☐ A systematic review of several double-blind randomised control trials.
- ☐ One or more large double-blind randomised control trials.
- ☐ One or more well-conducted cohort studies.
- ☐ One or more well-conducted case-control studies.

Your answer is incorrect.

Hierarchy of evidence I-1 Systematic review of several double-blind randomised control trials. I-2 One or more large double-blind randomised control trials. II-1 One or more well-conducted cohort studies. II-2 One or more well-conducted case-control studies. II-3 A dramatic uncontrolled experiment. III Expert Committee sitting in review; peer leader opinion. IV Personal experience.

The correct answer is: A systematic review of several double-blind randomised control trials.

Question 4

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following is true with respect to impact factor

Select one:

- ☐ It refers to the quality of a scientific journal
- ☐ It refers to the quality of an author
- ☐ It refers to the quality of a scientific article
- ☐ It is a static number that cannot be changed
- ☐ It is sensitive to the subject area of a journal

Your answer is incorrect.

The impact factor is a measure of the frequency with which the "average article" in a journal has been cited in a given period. The impact factor for a journal is calculated based on a three-year period, and can be considered to be the average number of times published papers are cited up to two years after publication (Retrieved from <http://journalseeker.researchbib.com/>). It is thus journal-specific and not article specific.

The correct answer is: It refers to the quality of a scientific journal

Question 5

Not answered

Marked out of 1

All of the following are natural steps in practising evidence-based medicine for a clinician except

Select one:

- ☐ Search and track down relevant evidence
- ☐ Critically appraise the evidence
- ☐ Formulate an answerable question
- ☐ Apply the evidence with consideration to patient's values
- ☐ Calculating impact factor of the journal

Your answer is incorrect.

The steps in evidence-based practice according to Glazsiou (2000) are 1. Formulate an answerable question. 2. Track down the best evidence of outcomes available. 3. Critically appraise the evidence (to find out how good it is and what it means). 4. Apply the evidence (integrate the results with clinical expertise and patient values).

The correct answer is: Calculating impact factor of the journal

Question 6

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Stephen, who is depressed, has come to your outpatient unit to discuss the possibility of taking fluoxetine. He is worried that this might affect his sexual performance. You know that the risk of this is recognised with fluoxetine but want to quote a precise number that he can understand. Which of the following population will you use as a comparator when formulating a query to search the literature

Select one:

- ☐ Depressed patients without sexual dysfunction
- ☐ General population
- ☐ Depressed patients not taking fluoxetine
- ☐ Non depressed patients taking fluoxetine
- ☐ Depressed patients on phenelzine

Your answer is incorrect.

What would Stephen do if he didn't take fluoxetine (the intervention) - it is very likely that, in this case, he might not be on anything rather than taking phenelzine. It makes more sense to the patient when side effects are discussed in comparison to not taking an intervention rather than taking an alternative intervention.

The correct answer is: Depressed patients not taking fluoxetine

Question 7

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following is presently the best resource to search for registered clinical trials?

Select one:

- ☐ MEDLINE
- ☐ Cochrane library
- ☐ Evidence Based Mental Health Online
- ☐ EMBASE
- ☐ Expert opinions

Your answer is incorrect.

At present, Cochrane register (Called CENTRAL) is an excellent resource for all registered clinical trials. One can even find information regarding on-going studies that are yet to be published.

The correct answer is: Cochrane library

Question 8

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following measures is the most effective in making clinicians apply a new clinical guideline in their practice?

Select one:

- ☐ Discussing the guidelines in academic meetings
- ☐ Creating online educational modules for the guidelines
- ☐ Experts approving the guidelines
- ☐ Using patient specific reminders related to the guidelines
- ☐ Publishing guidelines in peer reviewed journal

Your answer is incorrect.

Adherence with evidence-based recommendations for chronic disease management is often suboptimal. Providing patient-specific reminders at the time of clinical encounters has the potential to improve this situation (Retrieved from <http://www.nature.com/ebd/journal/v2/n3/full/6400038a.htm>).

The correct answer is: Using patient specific reminders related to the guidelines

Question 9

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following provides a consensus statement for reporting systematic reviews?

Select one:

- ☐ COCHRANE
- ☐ EMBASE
- ☐ CONSORT
- ☐ MEDLINE
- ☐ QUORUM

Your answer is incorrect.

Guidelines have now been published that should improve the reporting of clinical trials (CONSORT) and systematic reviews (QUORUM). These guidelines make it easier to judge research quality and should improve peer review: conclusions from clinical trials or systematic reviews using these guidelines are more likely to be reliable (Retrieved from <http://www.nature.com/ebd/journal/v2/n3/full/6400038a.html>).

The correct answer is: QUORUM

Question 10

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which of the following would be the most appropriate measure when explaining positive treatment response to patients?

Select one:

- ☐ Odds ratio of the intervention
- ☐ Control event rate
- ☐ Number Needed to Harm
- ☐ Relative Risk of intervening
- ☐ Number Needed to Treat

Your answer is incorrect.

Among the listed options, NNT is the best available tool to easily describe the benefits of a drug. But shortcomings of NNT include the lack of information regarding how long one needs a treatment and the adverse effects of a treatment. It does not convey how much better the patient will be after the treatment. Interestingly when a sample of the Danish population (n = 675) were asked whether they would consent to a hypothetical drug that reduces the risk of heart attack with the benefit of the drug expressed in terms of NNT randomly set at 10, 25, 50, 100, 200, and 400 etc., the proportion of people consenting to the hypothetical drug was observed to be about 80%, irrespective of NNT! Lay people may have difficulties in understanding the meaning of NNT, and clinicians may do well to use the NNT with caution until more is known about how patients comprehend it. Kristiansen IS, Gyrd-Hansen D, Nexoe J, et al. Number needed to treat: Easily understood and intuitively meaningful? Theoretical considerations and a randomized trial. J Clin Epidemiol 2002;55:888-92

The correct answer is: Number Needed to Treat

Question 11

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which one of the following bodies is formed to generate consensus guidelines in relation to healthcare?

Select one:

- ☐ STROBE
- ☐ CONSORT
- ☐ Cochrane
- ☐ NICE
- ☐ QUORUM

Your answer is incorrect.

The National Institute for Health and Clinical Excellence (NICE) is the independent organisation responsible for providing national guidance on the promotion of good health and the prevention and treatment of ill health. NICE produces guidance in three areas of health: public health, health technologies and clinical practice.

The correct answer is: NICE

Question 12

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which one of the following hierarchy is correct in evidence-based practice?

Select one:

- ☐ Qualitative research, systematic review, RCTs, non RCTs, cohort studies.
- ☐ Meta analysis, Systematic review, RCT, Non RCT, Cohort, Case Control.
- ☐ RCT, meta-analysis, cohort studies, case control studies, case reports.
- ☐ RCT, Non RCT, Cohort Study, Case Control, Meta analysis
- ☐ Expert opinion, narrative reviews, RCTs, Cohort studies

Your answer is incorrect.

The EBM hierarchy indicates the relative weight that can be attributed to a particular study design. The higher up a methodology is ranked, the more robust it is assumed to be. At one end lies the meta-analysis, synthesizing the results of a number of similar trials to produce a result of higher statistical power. At the other end of the spectrum lie observational studies thought to provide the weakest level of evidence. (From public-health-textbook issues by DoH - <http://www.healthknowledge.org.uk>)

The correct answer is: Meta analysis, Systematic review, RCT, Non RCT, Cohort, Case Control.

Question 13

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which one of the following is considered as a structured way to formulate a question when practising Evidence-Based Medicine ?

Select one:

- ☐ PICO format
- ☐ FICA format
- ☐ FICO format
- ☐ PICA format
- ☐ SICO format

Your answer is incorrect.

A structured way to formulate an EBM question is to specify the population, intervention, comparators and outcome, which are also known as the PICO format. This is a useful guideline for treatment studies but may not fit all questions.

The correct answer is: PICO format

Question 14

Not answered

Marked out of 1

Which one of the following is correct with regard to the Cochrane library?

Select one:

- ☐ Cochrane library does not have articles on mental health research
- ☐ Cochrane maintains a register of controlled trials
- ☐ Cochrane project will be completed in 2010
- ☐ All interventions studies are registered with the Cochrane
- ☐ Cochrane is an alternative index to Medline

Your answer is incorrect.

The Cochrane Library includes i. Regularly-updated systematic reviews and protocols for reviews in preparation prepared by the Cochrane collaboration of clinical researchers in the Cochrane Database of Systematic Reviews. ii. Quality appraisals of reviews published elsewhere are maintained in the Database of Abstracts of Reviews of Effectiveness. iii. A register of controlled trials, in the Cochrane Controlled Trials Register. Cochrane collaboration runs a continuous process of systematic appraisal and synthesis of clinical evidence. It is not an alternative to Medline. Despite the usefulness, not all intervention trials get registered in the Cochrane.

The correct answer is: Cochrane maintains a register of controlled trials

Question 15

Not answered

Marked out of 1

IN EBM the term PECO stands for

Select one:

- ☐ protect, experience, compare, Options
- ☐ patient, exposure, comparison, outcome.
- ☐ prevent, expert, classify, options
- ☐ project, experience, compute, output
- ☐ patient, expert, compulsion, option.

Your answer is incorrect.

PICO or PECO is a mnemonic used to describe the four elements of a good clinical foreground question in EBM. P—Patient; I—Intervention or E - Exposure; C—Comparison and O--Outcome

The correct answer is: patient, exposure, comparison, outcome.

Question 16

Not answered

Marked out of 1

A researcher is preparing to submit a manuscript reviewing the effectiveness of a specific anti-dementia drug. Which of the following is the most important conflict of interest that he must disclose during the submission?

Select one:

- ☐ Receiving honoraria for lecturing from a pharmaceutical company that supplies a competing drug
- ☐ Being paid for clinical consultation offered to patients with dementia
- ☐ Having previously prescribed competing antidementia drugs to patients
- ☐ Having a relative with dementia
- ☐ Working in an institution where colleagues unrelated to this study have received funding for dementia research

Your answer is incorrect.

Hidden biases can be caused by not declaring conflicts of interests in scientific publications.

The correct answer is: Receiving honoraria for lecturing from a pharmaceutical company that supplies a competing drug



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